

Guide to Spanish Imperative Conjugation

Introduction

The imperative mood in Spanish is used to **give commands, make requests, offer advice, or give instructions**. Unlike other verb tenses, the imperative does not have a **first-person singular (yo) form**, as one does not command oneself. However, it does include **tú, usted, ustedes, vosotros, and nosotros**, each of which follows a specific conjugation pattern.

In this guide, we will cover each form in detail, providing clear explanations, charts, irregular verb lists, and examples.

1. Tú (Informal Singular Command)

The **tú** form is used when giving commands to someone you address informally. It has two versions:

- **Affirmative Commands:** Use the **third-person singular (él, ella)** form of the **present indicative**.
- **Negative Commands:** Use the **second-person singular of the present subjunctive**.

Regular Verbs

Infinitive	Affirmative Tú	Negative Tú
Hablar (to speak)	Habla	No hables
Comer (to eat)	Come	No comas
Escribir (to write)	Escribe	No escribas

Irregular Affirmative Tú Commands

Some verbs have **irregular affirmative** commands that do not follow the usual pattern.

Verb	Affirmative Tú	Negative Tú
Decir (to say)	Di	No digas

Hacer (to do)	Haz	No hagas
Ir (to go)	Ve	No vayas
Poner (to put)	Pon	No pongas
Salir (to leave)	Sal	No salgas
Ser (to be)	Sé	No seas
Tener (to have)	Ten	No tengas
Venir (to come)	Ven	No vengas

Pronoun Placement in Tú Commands

- **Affirmative:** Attach pronouns to the end (e.g., *Cómelo* - Eat it)
- **Negative:** Place pronouns before the verb (e.g., *No lo comas* - Don't eat it)

2. Usted (Formal Singular Command)

The **usted** command is used when speaking formally or showing respect. It is formed using the **third-person singular of the present subjunctive**.

Regular Verbs

Infinitive	Affirmative Usted	Negative Usted
Hablar	Hable	No hable
Comer	Coma	No coma
Escribir	Escriba	No escriba

Irregular Usted Commands

These verbs use their **irregular subjunctive** forms:

Verb	Affirmative Usted	Negative Usted
Dar	Dé	No dé

Estar	Esté	No esté
Ir	Vaya	No vaya
Saber	Sepa	No sepa
Ser	Sea	No sea

Pronoun Placement in Usted Commands

- **Affirmative:** *Tráigalo, por favor* (Bring it, please)
- **Negative:** *No lo traiga* (Don't bring it)

3. Ustedes (Formal & Plural Command)

The **ustedes** form is used for addressing a group politely or formally. It is formed using the **third-person plural of the present subjunctive**.

Regular Verbs

Infinitive	Affirmative Ustedes	Negative Ustedes
Hablar	Hablen	No hablen
Comer	Coman	No coman
Escribir	Escriban	No escriban

Irregular Ustedes Commands

Verb	Affirmative Ustedes	Negative Ustedes
Dar	Den	No den
Estar	Estén	No estén
Ir	Vayan	No vayan
Saber	Sepan	No sepan
Ser	Sean	No sean

Pronoun Placement in Ustedes Commands

- **Affirmative:** *Díganmelo* (Tell it to me)
 - **Negative:** *No me lo digan* (Don't tell it to me)
-

4. Vosotros (Informal Plural Command - Spain Only)

The **vosotros** form is used when speaking to a group informally in Spain. It differs from other commands in that the **affirmative** form is derived from the **infinitive**, while the **negative** form follows the **present subjunctive**.

Regular Verbs

Infinitive	Affirmative Vosotros	Negative Vosotros
Hablar	Hablad	No habléis
Comer	Comed	No comáis
Escribir	Escribid	No escribáis

Irregular Vosotros Commands

Verb	Affirmative Vosotros	Negative Vosotros
Dar	Dad	No deis
Estar	Estad	No estéis
Ir	Id	No vayáis
Saber	Sabed	No sepáis
Ser	Sed	No seáis

Reflexive Verbs in Vosotros

For **affirmative** commands, remove the final **-d** and add **-os**.

Infinitive	Affirmative Vosotros	Negative Vosotros
Levantarse	Levantaos	No os levantéis

Vestirse	Vestíos	No os vistáis
----------	----------------	---------------

5. Nosotros (Let's Commands)

The **nosotros** command ("let's...") is formed using the **first-person plural of the present subjunctive**.

Regular Verbs

Infinitive	Affirmative Nosotros	Negative Nosotros
Hablar	Hablemos	No hablemos
Comer	Comamos	No comamos
Escribir	Escribamos	No escribamos

Reflexive Verbs in Nosotros Commands

For **affirmative nosotros** commands, drop the final **-s** before adding the reflexive pronoun **nos**.

Infinitive	Affirmative Nosotros	Negative Nosotros
Levantarse (to get up)	Levantémonos	No nos levantemos
Sentarse (to sit down)	Sentémonos	No nos sentemos
Vestirse (to get dressed)	Vistémonos	No nos vistamos
Acostarse (to go to bed)	Acuestémonos	No nos acostemos

Pronoun Placement in Nosotros Commands

- **Affirmative:** Pronouns are attached, and an accent is added for pronunciation (e.g., *Vámonos* - Let's go).
- **Negative:** Pronouns go before the verb (e.g., *No nos vayamos* - Let's not go).

This guide provides a thorough understanding of imperative conjugations in Spanish, with patterns, irregularities, and examples to master commands effectively.